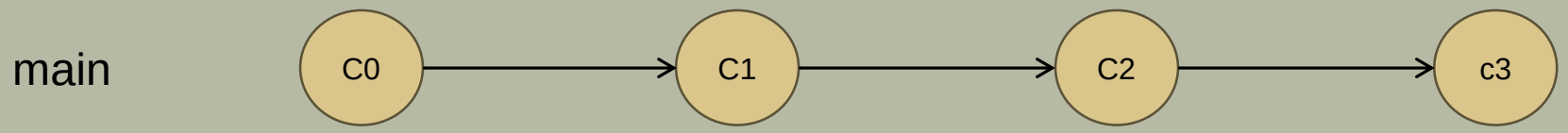
Going deeper with branches and good practices

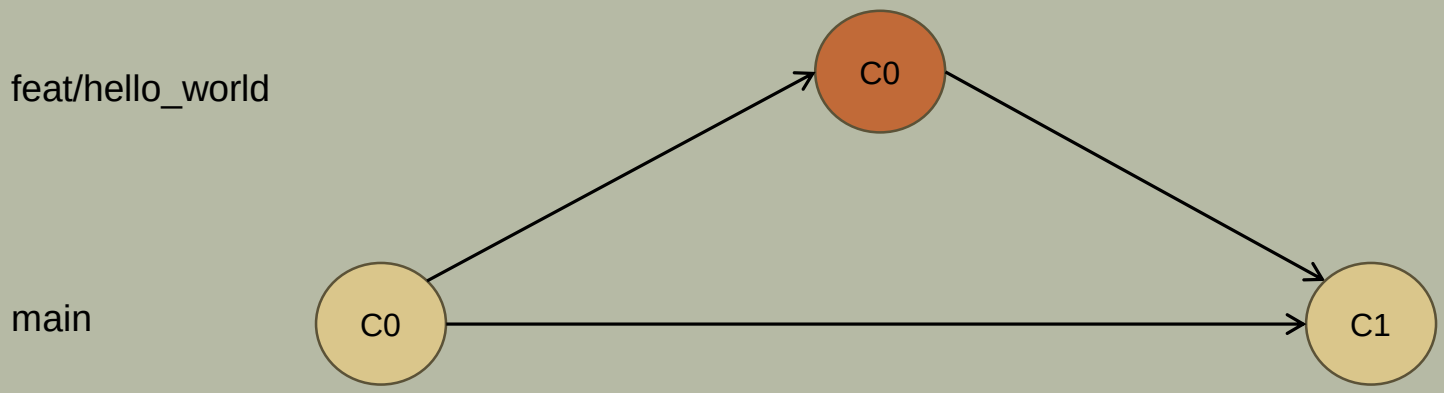
- An overview of branches
- How to create, push and delete a branch
- Handle a merge conflict
- helpful R tool: create a renv
- Good practices and resources

An overview of branches



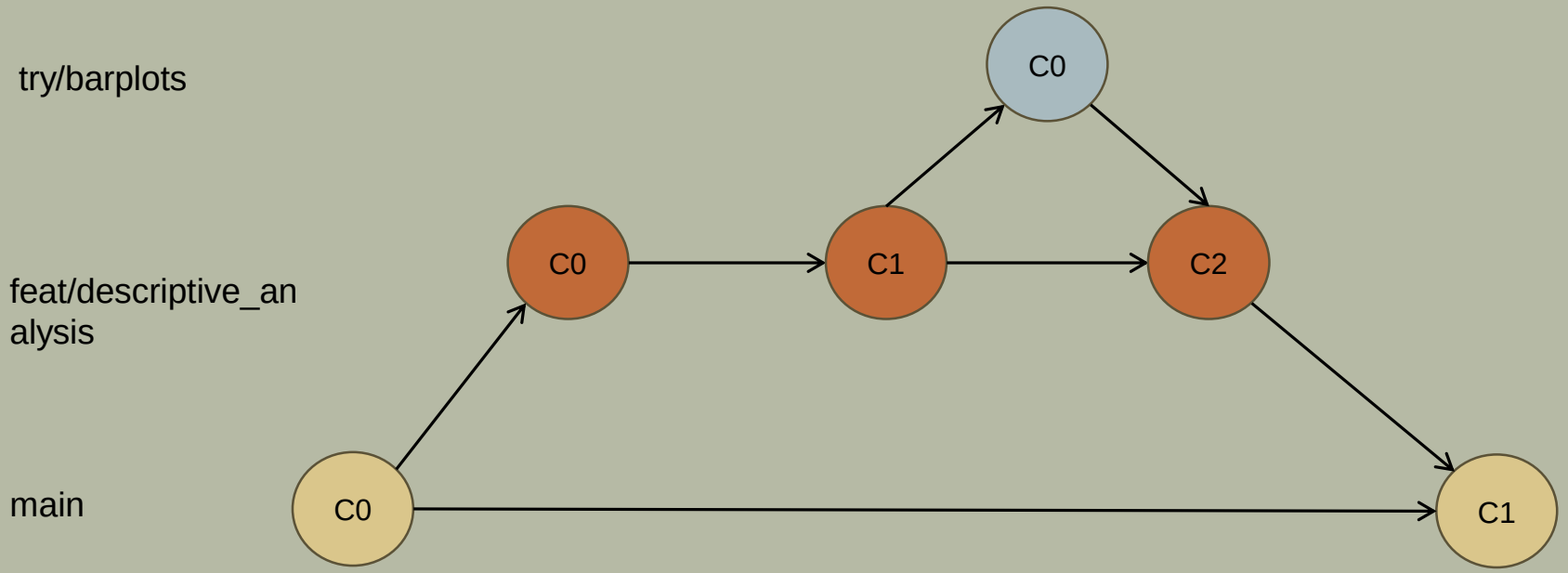
This is how we did it since now, but the rule will be to NEVER work on the main !

An overview of branches



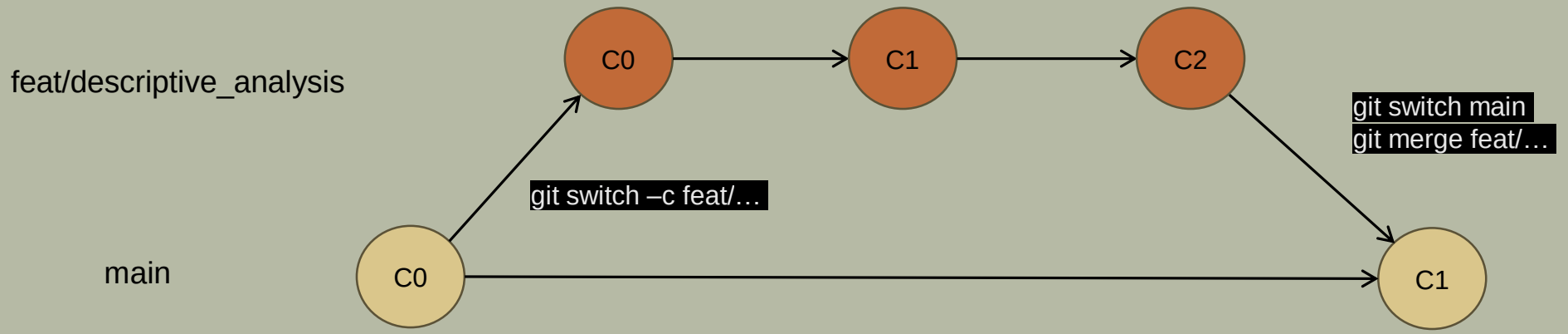
Always open a new branch, even for a small change !

An overview of branches



When you are unsure about a new change, open a new branch on the first one, and merge (or not) when you decide.

An overview of branches



Demo

Create a branch, commit changes and merge it to the main with gitlab

How to handle a merge conflict

Collaborative work in R: renv

The renv package[1] helps you create **r**eproducible **env**ironments for your R projects. Use renv to make your R projects more isolated, portable and reproducible.



install.packages("renv")

renv::init() at the root of your repository

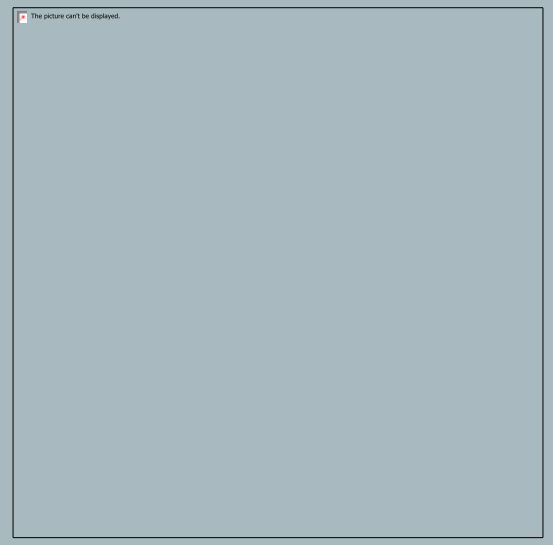
renv::snapshot when you have installed or upgrade packages

renv::restore() to reinstall the specific package versions recorded in the lockfile



(1) https://rstudio.github.io/renv/

Good practices



- git pull before begin to work
- git branch or git status before begin to work
- Small frequent commit, with a useful message
- Never work directly on the main (yes even alone)
- Careful when using git add . that you have all it should be into your .gitignore
- Any data directly into Gitlab
- Avoid git push –force or git reset –hard, there is usually more peaceful solution
- Use a .env file and tools as renv to work in good collaboration

Useful resources

- If you want to be more comfortable with git:
  - git book, chapter 1, 2 and 3 https://git-scm.com/book/en/v2
  - A game to learn git: https://learngitbranching.js.org

- If you need a rapid answer:
  - git cheat sheet: https://git-scm.com/cheat-sheet
  - our survival guide: https://g-lck.github.io/Git-and-GitLab-Guide/Git_Survival_Guide/Survival_Guide.html

Thank you for your attention

- Follow the last guide on git branch (close to what we did today)
- A survival guide as been added, that’s not an exercise, just a file to refer when you will have something to do or a problem <3

Publish your own work !

And don’t hesitate to ask a meeting to do it together

